sion adjusting itself at every micro second to the imperfections of the road, I enjoy the complete transformation of the software backbone of the car (autonomous driving capability added but not yet enabled) and its outward manifestations available through the new screen. This 4th generation MBUX hyperscreen has three screens instead of the earlier two. The 12.3in passenger screen and the 14.4in central screen are behind the same glass panel while the instrument panel is on another 12.3in floating display. With such advanced computing, the 4th gen MBUX now provides the latest version of ChatGPT, Microsoft Bing and Google Gemini built in while the on-board navigation run off Google Maps.

The 450e that is launched in India features a total output of 435bhp and peak torque of 680Nm. It will get up to 100kmph in 5.7 seconds and now features a 27.8kWh battery pack that can drive the car up to 115km as per WLTP and to a top speed of 140kmph on electricity alone.

It is such irony that while I am driving along the wind-swept beaches of the German Riviera that is meant to transport you back to the future, I am doing it in a car that is future proof and fitted with cutting edge technology. Mercedes seems to have added intelligence to every core of the car and while the car is not revolutionary, it is better than before in every aspect. Launching with the plug-in hybrid is another master stroke for India because it will differentiate the car and keep it in that exalted, most coveted, space that it has made its own over the years. The car is priced at₹2.2 crore for the launch edition that is a CBU (Completely Built Unit) and while booking are open, deliveries are expected to start around Diwali, promising a big bang release.









★★

BOARD & LODGE

Where
The Fontenay
Cost
Rooms start upwards of €400 (₹43,500) per night
www.fontenay.com

Where
Weissenhaus – Private Nature Luxury Resort
Cost
Rooms are upwards of 500 euros (₹54,200) per night
www.weissenhaus.de

Where
Lakeside Restaurant (2 Michelin stars)
Cost
Seven-course menu 275€ (₹30,000) (+165€ (₹18,000) for 7 glasses wine pairing)
https://www.thefontenay.com/en/restaurants-bar/lakeside-restaurant/

★★